

SILVER

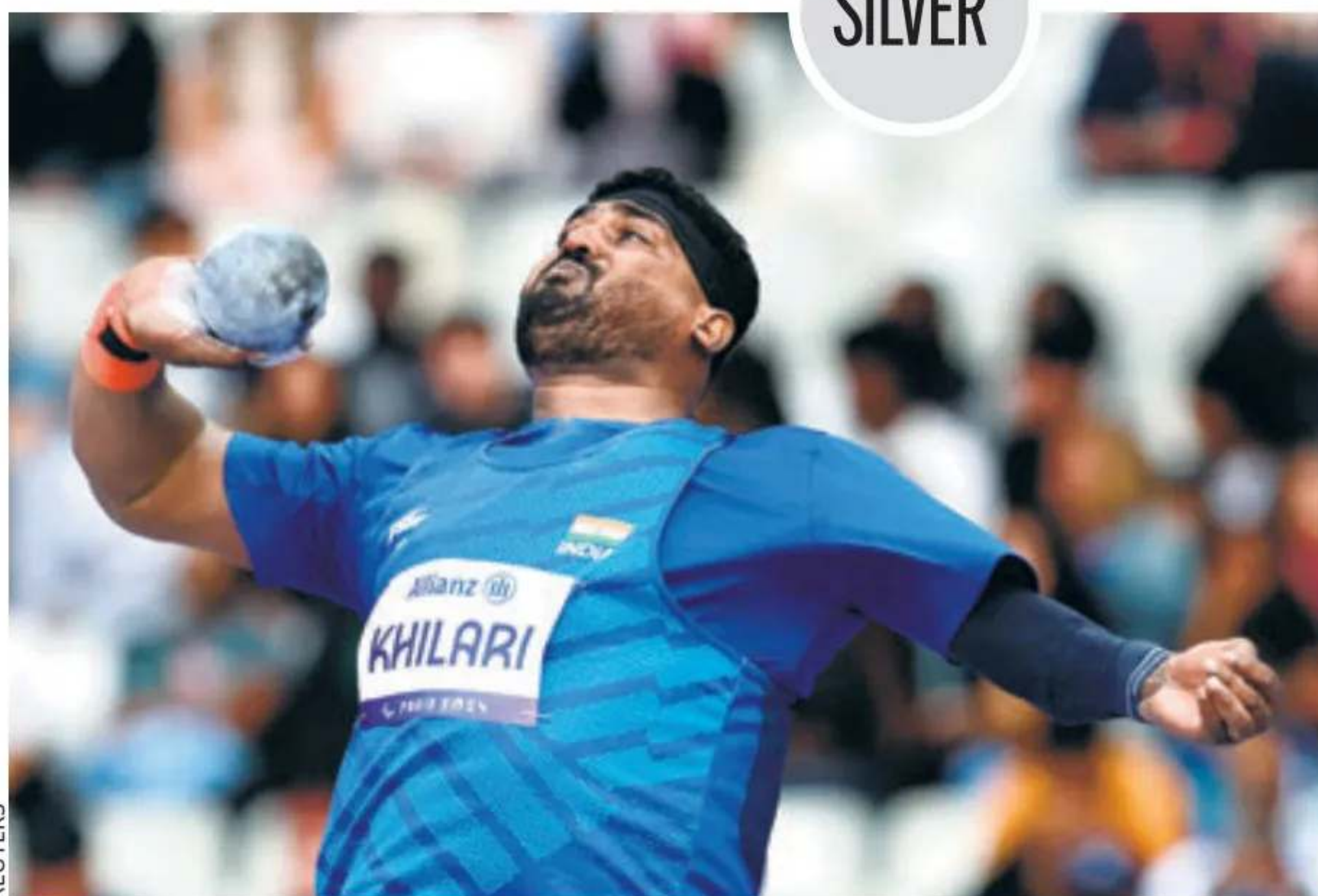
» SACHIN KHILARI

Category: Athletics (Men's Shot Put F46)

Sachin Khilari won a silver medal at the Paris Paralympics in the men's shot put F46 category, which is for athletes with arm deficiencies, impaired muscle power, or limited range of motion in their arms, competing in a standing position. The 34-year-old achieved this with an impressive Asian record throw of 16.32m.

As a child, Khilari suffered a bicycle accident that led to permanent damage, limiting the movement in his left hand. Despite these challenges, he pursued his athletic dreams, initially competing in javelin before switching to shot put due to a shoulder injury.

In 2023, he won his first world para title with an Asian record throw of 16.21m at the World Para Athletics Championships. He continued his success with another title at the Asian Para Games. At the 2024 World Para Athletics Championships, Khilari set a new personal best throw of 16.30m to secure gold once again.



REUTERS

» PRANAV SOORMA

Category: Athletics (Men's Club Throw F51)

India achieved five double-podium finishes at the Paris 2024 Paralympics, with the standout performance coming in the men's club throw F51 event. Dharambir secured gold with a new Asian record throw of 34.92m, while Pranav Soorma took silver with a throw of 34.59m.

This result reversed the podium positions from the previous year's Asian Games. For Pranav, who works as an assistant manager at a nationalised bank, achieving such a performance in his debut Paralympics signals promising future prospects.

Pranav became quadriplegic at age 16 when the roof of his house collapsed on him in 2011, causing severe spinal cord damage and resulting in the loss of movement in his legs and hands.

In the F51 category, athletes sit in a throwing frame within a circle consisting of a chair and a vertical pole. They have all six attempts at once and use a sticky substance to grip the wooden club, which weighs approximately 400g.



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